

Vision and Scope

Sep 8th, 2026

How Software ¢orp Landed the Project

The City of Houston issued a request for proposals looking for a technology partner to modernize parking across its downtown district. Years of driver complaints about circling blocks for an open spot, paired with parking operators struggling to track occupancy and revenue in real time, pushed the city to look for a software fix instead of pouring more concrete into new garages.

Software ¢orp submitted a proposal for a mobile and web platform that gives drivers real-time visibility into open spaces, lets them reserve and pay ahead of time, and gives operators a dashboard to manage pricing and monitor usage. The city selected Software ¢orp based on our track record with large-scale platform development and our ability to move fast without the usual budget fights slowing things down.

About Software ¢orp

Software ¢orp is a software development studio built around one idea: give the team the resources and time to build something right, without budget constraints getting in the way. We work across mobile, web, and backend systems, pulling together small teams of specialists for each project instead of running everything through one generalist crew.

For the Smart Parking Platform, we've assembled dedicated teams covering mobile, web, backend/API, mapping and location services, payment integration, and QA, each one focused on their piece of the system while staying synced through the project as a whole.

What the Smart Parking Platform Actually Is

At its core, the Smart Parking Platform is an app and companion website that takes the guesswork out of finding parking. Drivers open the app, see a live map of nearby garages with open spots, pick one, reserve it, and pay before they even leave the house. No more driving in circles hoping something opens up.

On the operator side, parking facilities get a dashboard showing occupancy in real time, revenue tracking, and reporting tools to help price smarter and run garages more efficiently. The platform connects drivers who need a spot with operators who have one, and cuts the friction out of both sides.

Why This Platform, and Why Now

Existing parking platforms solve pieces of the problem but leave real gaps. Competitor research across SpotHero, ParkMobile, ParkWhiz, and Passport Parking shows a pattern: unreliable real-time availability, pricing that isn't clear until checkout, and slow or rigid processes when something goes wrong. Locally, ParkHouston adds its own issues on top of that, frequent app downtime, delayed two-factor verification, and a reputation as a target for scams, all of which erode driver trust in the system they're supposed to rely on.

The Smart Parking Platform is built to close these specific gaps. Real-time availability will pull from verified garage data rather than static listings, cutting down on the "phantom spot" problem that plagues SpotHero and ParkWhiz. Pricing will be shown in full before a driver ever confirms a reservation, no surprise fees at checkout. Dispute and refund requests will run through a faster resolution process instead of the rigid, slow-response systems seen in Passport and ParkHouston. And because reliability is the trust problem here, not just a feature problem, the platform will be built with uptime and account security treated as core requirements, not afterthoughts.

In short: competitors-built parking apps. Software corp is building a parking platform drivers and operators can trust to work when they need it.

Claude AI was used to brainstorm the outline of this paper

Prompt used: how should I format the vision and scope

How I Changed it: Used it as an outline to the actual paper so that I don't ramble

Answer it gave me:

For something like this in a formal SRS-style doc, you want clear hierarchy so it reads well and plugs into your table of contents later. Here's how I'd structure it:

1. Section heading

"Vision and Scope" as a main heading (Heading 1 style if you're in Word, since your project needs a working TOC).

2. Subsections as Heading 2

Break it into the same chunks we've been using:

- How Software ¢orp Landed the Project
- About Software ¢orp
- What the Smart Parking Platform Actually Is
- Why This Platform, and Why Now

Each one gets its own Heading 2, so it shows up nested under "Vision and Scope" in the TOC.

3. Paragraph style, not bullets

This section reads more like a narrative/pitch than a spec, so keep it as prose paragraphs rather than bullet points. Save the bullets for your use cases and requirements lists later on.

4. Keep paragraphs short

2-4 sentences per paragraph max. Big walls of text look unprofessional in an SRS doc and make it harder to skim.

5. Optional: pull quote or callout

Since your last line ("competitors built parking apps, Software ¢orp is building a platform people can trust") is basically your thesis statement, some people bold it or set it apart as a standalone line at the end of that section. Not required, but it reads well as a closer.

Since your assignment specifically calls for header, footer, TOC, and image captions in the final doc, this needs to live in an actual Word file with heading styles applied correctly (that's what makes the TOC auto-generate). Want me to build this into a proper docx with the headings set up right now, so you've got the formatting locked in instead of guessing at it in Word yourself?